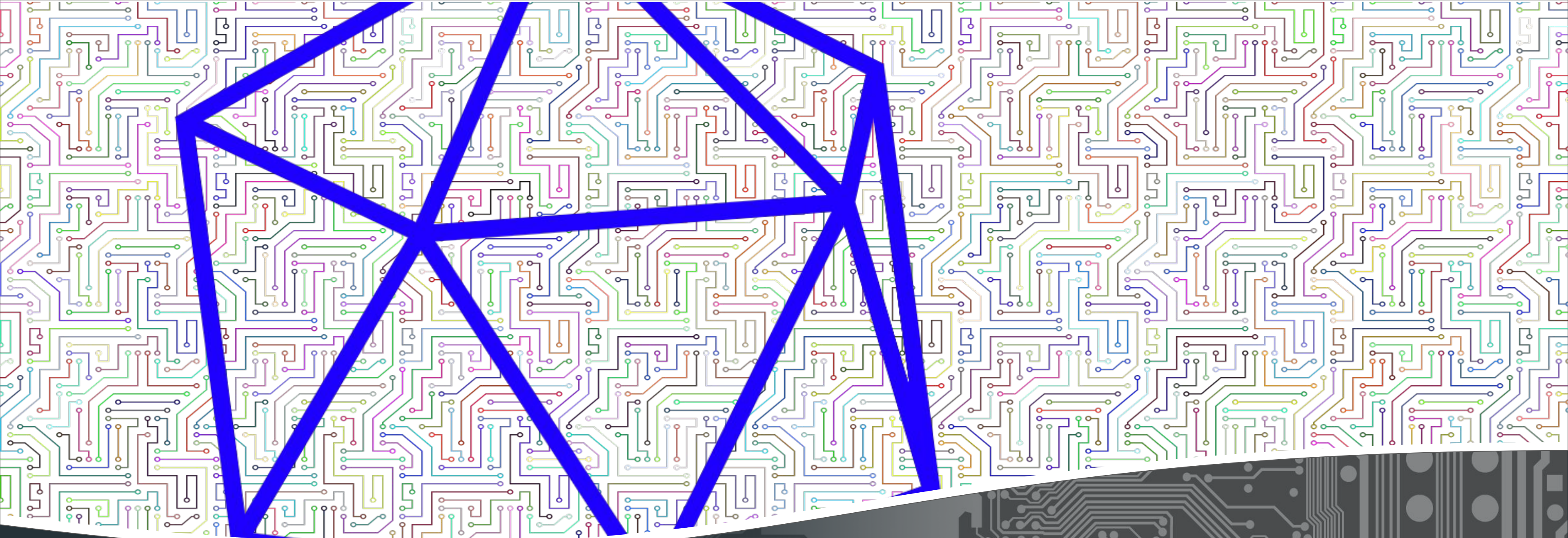
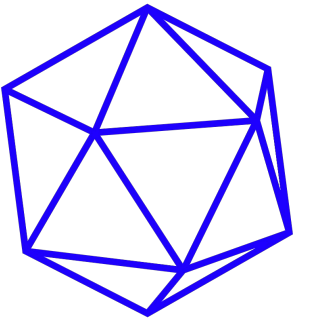




Object Pascal Foundation

Draft Proposal | 2024-04-21
Jim McKeeth | jim@mckeeth.org

Disclaimer

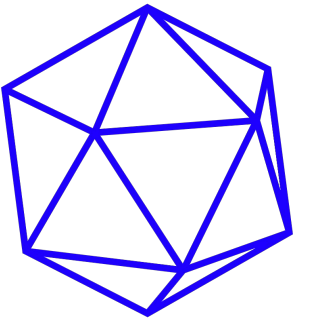


- This is a draft proposal and does not necessarily represent the opinions or plans of any other individual or organization that may or may not have contributed or commented on this proposal
- As this is an early draft proposal, it is subject to change as the conversation evolves
- Expressing interest in the foundation doesn't indicate endorsement

Outline/Overview

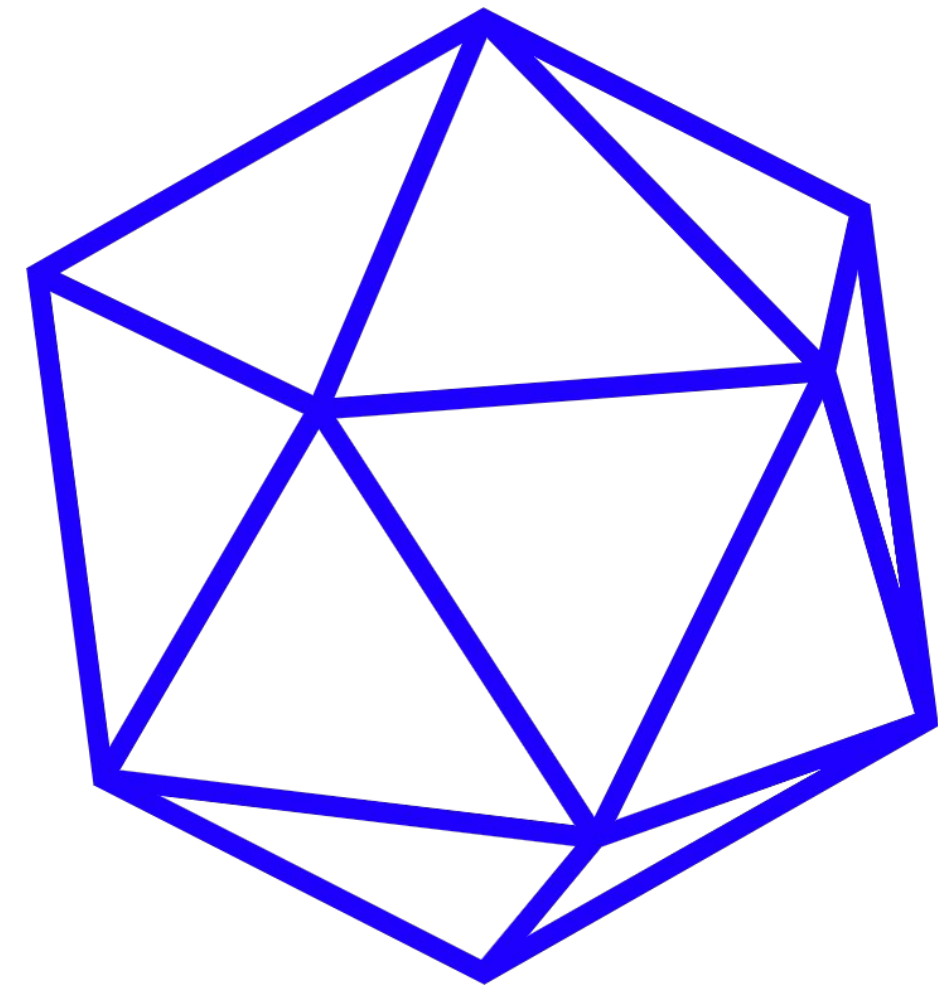
- Propositions
- Goals & Non-Goals
- Competition
- Naming
- Potential Members
- Outcomes & Objectives
- Why the Icosahedron?
- Next Steps...

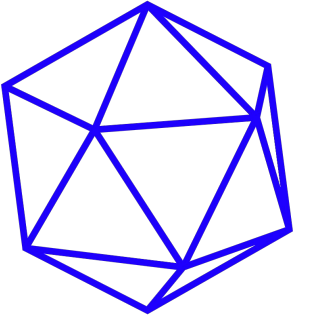
This is less of a presentation, and more of an outline organized on slides.
Feel free to comment (request access if you are unable to comment.)



Resources

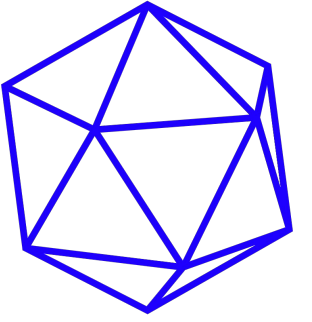
- Share these slides
- Website coming soon
 - objectpascal.foundation
 - github.com/ObjectPascalFoundation/
- [Sign-up](#) for more information
- List of [respondents](#)





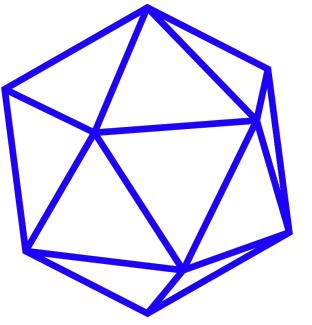
Basic Ideas/Propositions

- Object Pascal, in its various flavors/dialects/implementations, is a powerful, modern, and useful language
- Object Pascal is a family of languages with different names and features
- Object Pascal is bigger than any one of the organizations involved
- Most developers use more than one development tool; either within a single project or across multiple projects
- There is value in developers having access to multiple Object Pascal tools
- Within the larger developer community more can be done to promote Object Pascal as a whole (common syntax highlighting, tutorials, etc.)
- Collaboration is a good thing - when we work together we each reach further
- Promoting the good in each is better than emphasizing the bad in the others



Goals

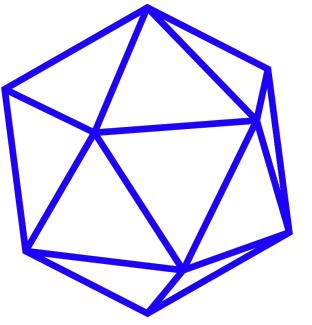
- Show Object Pascal is alive, modern, useful, and evolving
- Answer “*Why Object Pascal?*” with a ***hurrah*** instead of an *apology*
- Promote all Object Pascal implementations
 - For development, education, research, etc.
- Expand acceptance and support of Object Pascal in tools and online
- Collaborate for the future of Object Pascal
- Create a consolidated directory of Object Pascal related & supporting tools
- Promote each implementation/tool without the need to attack or denigrate
- Focus on individual strengths and features
- Promote interoperability and compatibility where it exists
- Embrace and celebrate the future of Object Pascal



Not a “Standard” and Not a “Regulation”

These are non-goals and things specifically avoided

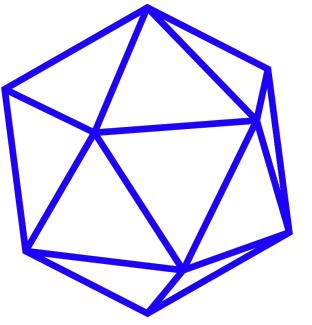
- Not creating a “standard” that implementations *should* follow
 - This isn’t about taking autonomy away. Anyone can implement Object Pascal with the language features they want. How implementers choose to be compatible is up to them.
- No regulating how or what anyone calls their implementation
 - If some decides their Object Pascal based language is now called Steve and isn’t Object Pascal that is their choice.
 - Likewise if someone makes a language that looks like C, but they want to say it is Object Pascal based/influenced that is fine too.
- Not restrict the behaviors or actions of members
 - We do ask that foundation members not denigrate other implementations, but the foundation does not restrict or censure member actions.



Formalized Definition of Interoperability

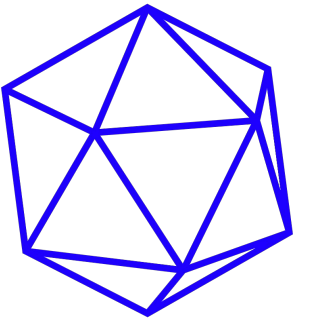
The “don’t call it a standard” standard - but maybe eventually call it a standard if everyone agrees.

- Languages should be slow to add features since they are hard to remove once developers are using them
- Delphi and Object Pascal have a strong focus on backward compatibility.
 1. Formalize the superset of language syntax and features used by all implementations
 2. Select what everyone agrees on as the “definition”
 3. Conversations can take place on how to improve compatibility and interoperability, and how to move the language forward
 4. Potentially two definitions: One for scripting OP implementations and one for non-scripting implementations



Which is the **Best** Object Pascal?

- This is an irrelevant question
- Each implementor has different goals and can believe and state theirs is the best at reaching their goals
- There are obvious overlaps in goals. There is nothing wrong with saying: “we believe we are the best or better because we do the following
- Focusing on your strengths is better than saying “*we are better because the other implementations are bad.*”
 - If you are only *better* by comparison with something that is *bad*, then you aren’t very *good*
- McDonalds and Burger King never criticize hamburgers



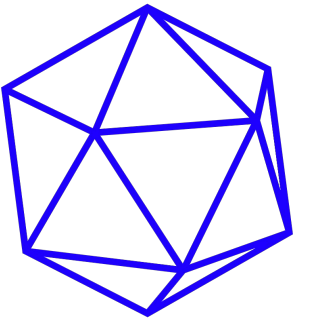
But Competition!?!

- Programming languages and tools is not a zero sum game
- One does not have to lose for another to win
- A developer is more likely to choose Object Pascal if they see multiple options/vendors supporting them
- Apple, Google, Microsoft, and Samsung all compete, and work together
- Competition is a good thing - this isn't about price fixing or other anti-competitive practices
- McDonalds and Burger King never criticize burgers



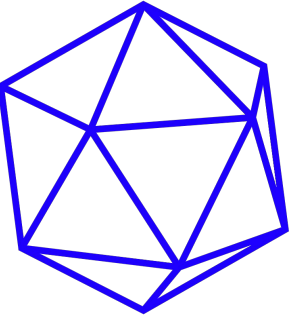
Object Pascal vs. Pascal

- Object Pascal is the evolution of Pascal
- Object Pascal is a family of implementations and dialects
- The preference for naming is Object Pascal (or OP), but dialects and implementations are welcome to use other names
- Component Pascal, Modula, Oberon, etc. may also belong (if implementers want to....)



*What's in a name?
That which we call
Object Pascal by any
other name would be as
neat!*

Potential Member Organizations/Implementations



- Blaise Pascal
- DWScript
- Elevate Web Builder
- Embarcadero's Delphi
- Fast Report's Fast Script
- Free Pascal
- GNU Pascal
- Lazarus
- ModernPascal
- RemObjects' Oxygene & PascalScript
- Smart Mobile Studio
- TMS WebCore
- Utilibo
- *Other Object Pascal Scripting implementations*
- *Other Object Pascal Compilers*

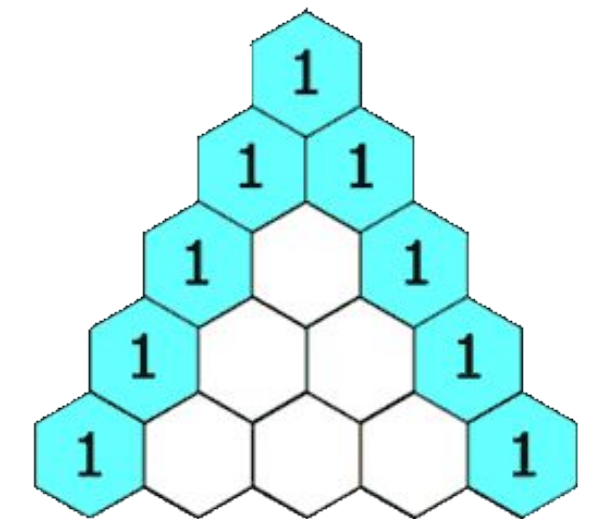
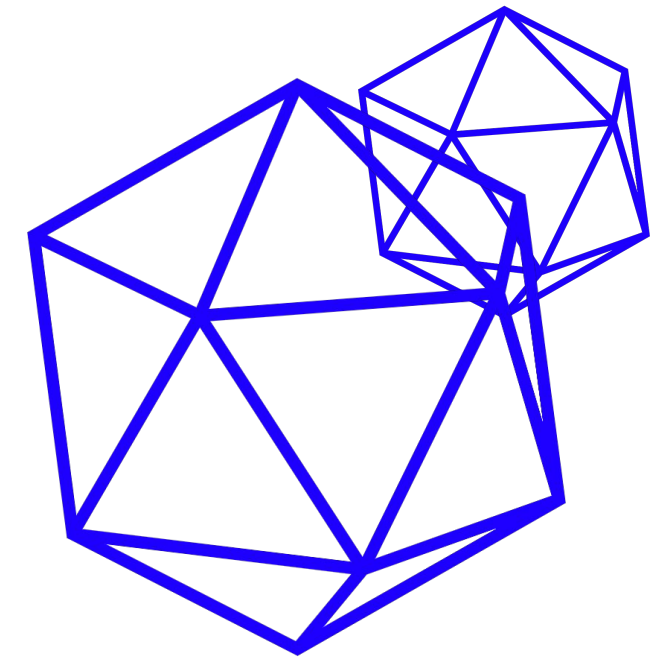
Outcomes

- Website promoting Object Pascal and the Foundation
- Answer “Why Object Pascal?” with a ***hurrah*** and not an *apology*
- References on interoperability and compatibility
- Promote Object Pascal inclusion in other tools and directories
- Promote Object Pascal in Education, Industry, and Hobby
- Directory of members and their products
- Directory of tools supporting Object Pascal
- Directory of clubs and community groups
- Directory of books and resources



Why the Icosahedron

- The regular icosahedron has 20 faces, 30 edges and 12 vertices
- It is one of the five Platonic solids, and the one with the most sides
 - 4-Tetrahedron, 6-Cube, 8-Octahedron, 10-Dodecahedron, 20-Icosahedron
- Blaise Pascal is known for Pascal's Triangle, and the icosahedron is made up of triangular faces
- Blaise Pascal contributed to probability theory, and since ancient times the icosahedron has been used as a twenty sided dice
- Just as an icosahedron has many sides, so does the Object Pascal Foundation
- All the sides of the icosahedron work together as one



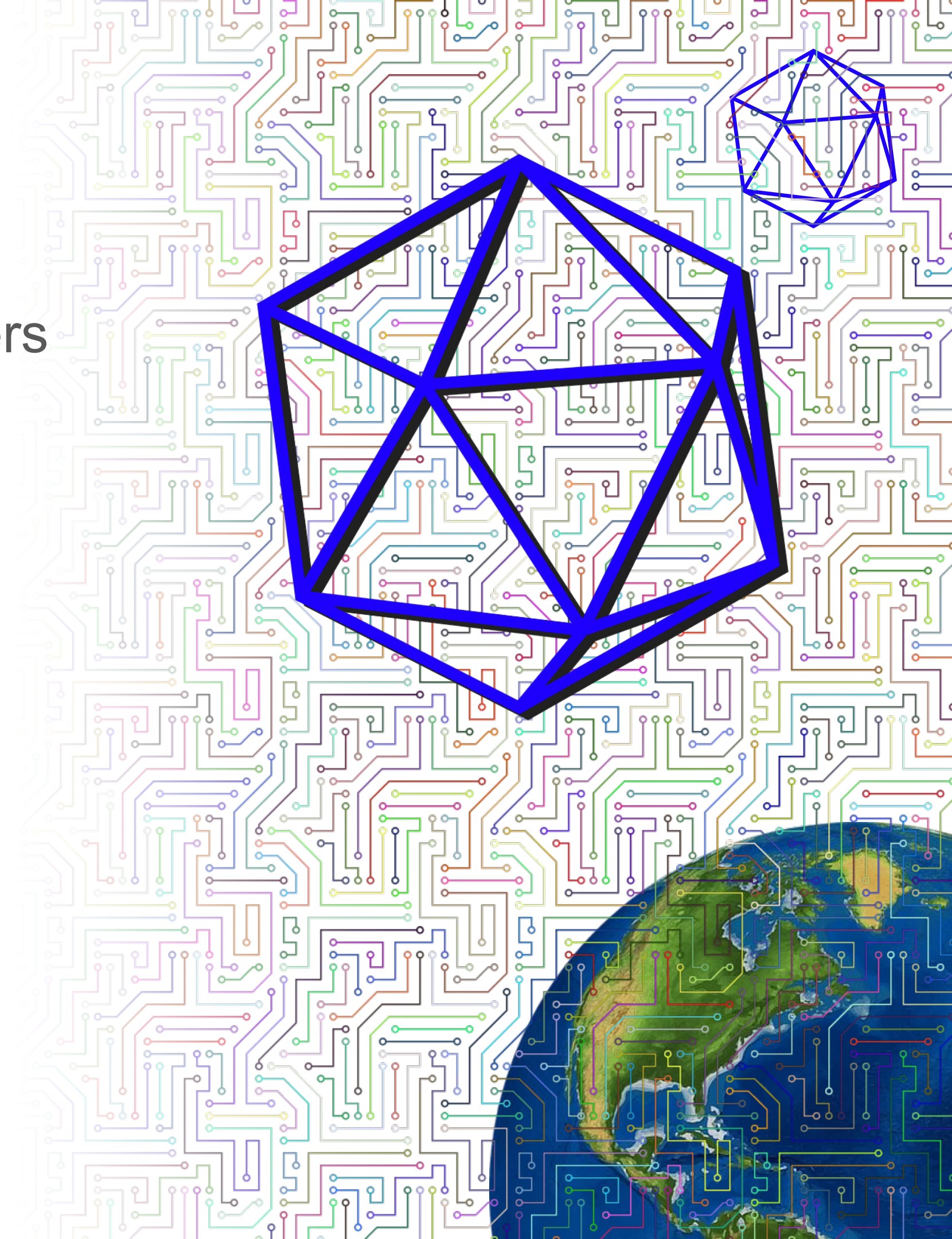
Pascal's Triangle - a triangular array of the binomial coefficients

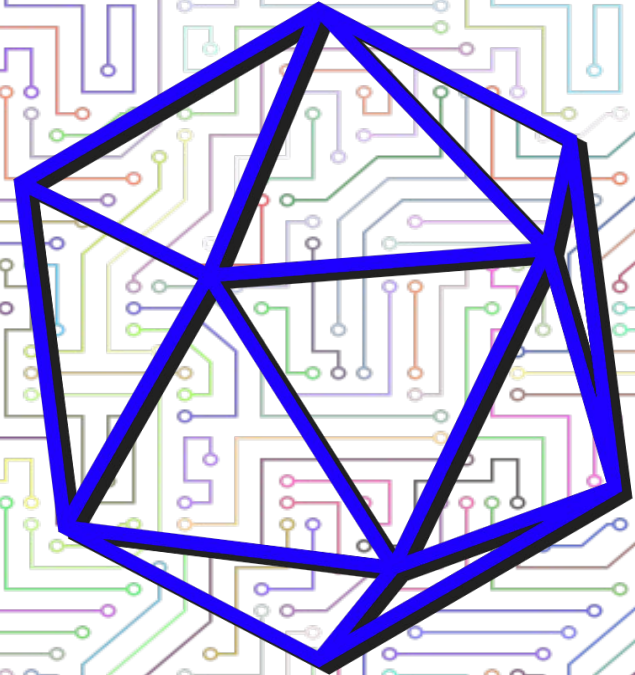


Twenty-sided die from Ptolemaic Egypt

Next Steps

1. Identify and invite additional potential members
2. Setup Website
3. Meet to discuss
4. Work out organizational details
5. Collect resources and populate directories
6. Promote Object Pascal
7. ???
8. Profit?
9. World domination?





Object Pascal Foundation

